

School: Thorpe St Andrews

Date: 03/07/23

Report: DPE Onsite audit walk **DPE consultant:** Stuart Lee (SL) **School:** Richard Wright

Thorpe St Andrews is a large high school and sixth form college with over 1800 students on roll. The school is part of the Broad Horizon Education Trust.

An onsite visit took place on the 3rd July 2023. This was arranged to complete a physical afterschool audit of the school. The audits support the Trust and school with identifying improvements and mitigating data protection, cyber and information security risks.

A selection of classrooms, offices and resource rooms were inspected. Folders and online systems are used for sharing data securely. CPOMS is used for Safeguarding. Salto key fob secure access was in place.

The audit walk recommendations have been detailed below inline with the audit walk observations. The audit walk and observations/feedback can be accessed here: [96151](#) This will include links to relevant best practice areas and policy documentation.

Visitors sign in

Observations: No visitor privacy information was detailed on the system when signing in.

Recommendations:

- Add the following statement to the visitor sign in system: Visitor information is collected for health and safety, record of official visits and safeguarding. If you would like to know more, the general/visitors privacy notice is available on the Trust/school website, or you can ask at reception for a paper copy. More guidance regarding visitor sign in systems is available [here](#).

External doors and entrances

Observations: external doors were left wedged open and there was unrestricted access from the Pound Lane entrance – this was due to the gate being left open (end of school day).

Recommendations:

- Review afterschool security and what areas can be accessed.
- Raise awareness of risks when wedging external doors open.

IT technicians office

Observation: The school security safe door was open with key left in and backup disks easily accessible; administrator laptop unlocked with applications open; external hard drives laying openly on a desktop; SALTO reader easily accessible; AS level student exam login details on display on the notice board and emails/paper left on desk detailing personal information.

Recommendations:

- Additional training and awareness for the staff member(s) to be completed.
- Practice of the clear desk and physical/information security policy.

- Review information security policies.
- Follow up review of the work area to take place after training and awareness has been completed.

DPEs information security best practice area with additional guidance/policy documents and best practice is located [here](#).

Reception/front office(s)

Observations: Mainly positive observation with a clear desk policy being observed. Areas were clear of clutter. Exam address labelled envelopes and certificates observed.

Recommendation:

- As the reception office is open plan, staff will need to remain vigilant to any information left out at the end of the school day and add to secure storage.

Under stage storage

Observations: old desktop units and excessive paper records stored in this area including historical Safeguarding data.

Recommendation:

- The whole area would benefit by having a total declutter (i.e. old desktop base units).
- Review and assess Safeguarding data in line with the Trusts retention schedule and securely destroy data no longer needed. For data to be retained, the school can consider developing procedures and processes to scan these to a secure electronic system.

DPEs record management best practice area is located [here](#).

Staffroom(s)

Observations: door wedged open; student letter on table; secure waste bin overflowing.

Recommendations:

- Reminder to staff not to leave doors wedged open.
- Review confidential waste contracts and procedures for ensuring waste bins are emptied routinely and before they become full and overflowing.
- North side - pigeon holes - review if these are still needed.

Classrooms, resource room and teaching and learning offices

Observations: Some sensitive data observed; exam access arrangements; unit reading sheets; OCR technical paperwork; N&N care plan and staff performance management for JL.

Some areas would benefit from a declutter.

Contractors were working in areas where sensitive data was in view and/or easily accessible.

Recommendations:

- Review [Physical Security Policy](https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/documents/procedures/146-dpe-model-physical-security-policy) (<https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-library/documents/procedures/146-dpe-model-physical-security-policy>).
- Continue to raise staff awareness and review and implement additional training for staff as appropriate.
- **Medical Guidance:** Lists that contain data such as: ethnicity, gender, SEN; pupil premium, date of birth, medical information etc could be located in folders. Make sure these are

stored securely when unattended. <https://dataprotection.education/best-practice-update/388-displaying-special-category-information-in-schools>

- Remind staff to add any folders that contain sensitive data (exams/assessment/intervention/performance management etc) to available storage (end of day routines).
- Where sensitive data is added to cabinets, remind staff to secure and not leave keys in cabinets.
- Staff should assess areas prior to contractors starting to work to ensure no sensitive data is in view or easily accessible.

Note: In the kitchen area of the raise and achievement office there was medical information of a student with cancer. The parents are aware that this information is displayed, although the school will need to consider who else can access this information i.e. contractors etc. The school can also consider minimising this data further and having it covered and/or a folder/online system. In addition, is the student aware that this information is on open display? School to review.

Data/exam offices

Observations: Generally positive observations with restricted access to offices. Some files are currently being cleansed and 1 x post-it note with personal information was observed. Some exam envelopes with addresses observed.

Recommendation:

- Reminder to staff to not use post-it notes that reveal personal/sensitive information.
- Continue a data cleanse of folders.

Caretakers office

Observations: Unlocked laptop with applications open including email etc. Able to access staff drive and medical information; unlocked drawers; minibus keys left on desk; bunch of keys laying on desk; visitor book on open display; key cupboard unlocked; signature list on open display.

Office would benefit with a declutter (clear desk).

Recommendations:

- Additional training and awareness for the staff member(s) to be completed.
- Practice of the clear desk and physical/information security policy.
- Follow up review of the work area to take place after training and awareness has been completed.

General follow ups:

- Action recommendations from the walk and complete a follow up walk Autumn term 2023.
- Continue to raise staff awareness.
- Review staff training completed and any additional training requirements for individual staff members.
- Review and recirculate current data/information security policy documentation and ensure this aligns with practice.

Note: DPE to work with RW to update the ICO accountability tracker and Trust plan for 2023/24.